

YANG LI

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EDUCATION

Simon Fraser University, Canada

Aug. 2025–Present

M.A. in Economics

Core GPA: 4.25/4.33

Nankai University, China

Aug. 2022–Jun. 2025

M.A. in Economics

GPA: 3.3/4.0

Hunan University, China

Aug. 2018–Jun. 2022

B.A. in Economics, with Honors

Core GPA: 4.0/4.0

RESEARCH INTEREST

Labor Economics; Gender Economics

WORKING PAPER

Old-Age Pensions and Three-Generation Household Reorganization: Evidence from

2026

Rural China (*with Xinhao Dong*)

Presented at the 2026 CEA Annual Conference.

Scheduled for presentation at the 2027 North American Winter Meeting of the Econometric Society (ASSA)

- Study how China's 2016 rural pension benefit increase reshapes childcare, migration, medical spending, and intergenerational transfers within three-generation households.
- Use the reform's age-60 eligibility cutoff in a difference-in-differences framework to identify how pension eligibility changes grandparent, parent, and grandchild outcomes.
- Find that pension eligibility raises grandchild care provision, reduces precautionary medical spending and downward transfers to adult children, and reorganizes parental migration toward shorter-distance, more returnable work trips.

Global Value Chains, Specialized Inputs, and Sino–U.S. Trade Friction: Evidence from China's Customs Data

2024

- Develop a generalized input–output accounting framework that allows for destination- and product-specific intermediate input use by combining WIOD tables with China's HS8-level customs data.
- Construct foreign value-added measures under heterogeneous input structures, relaxing the proportional-use assumption in standard TiVA methodologies.
- Show that conventional TiVA measures can substantially understate U.S. value added embodied in China's exports, especially in electronics and other high-tech sectors.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Shared Models, Shared Bias: LLMs and Statistical Discrimination

2026

Work in progress.

- Study how LLM use in hiring reshapes statistical discrimination by pushing employers toward shared gender-occupation beliefs.
- Build a model that joins DeGroot belief updating with search and matching. Shared LLM signals collapse the variance of beliefs across employers and turn structural embedding bias into equilibrium hiring bias.
- Show that the implied gender wage gap grows with the square of how much firms rely on LLMs. Use the model to compare two options: limiting adoption versus governing models at the training stage.

Gender Norms, Institutional Employment, and Marriage–Labor Market Sorting in China

2026

Work in progress.

- Ask whether joint sorting in the marriage and labor markets holds in China, and how traditional gender norms distort positive assortative matching.
- Use CFPS matched-couple data and lagged gender-norm attitudes. Link spousal education sorting, occupational task complexity, and time use within the household.
- Find early evidence that traditional gender norms weaken high-skill matching and pull women's time away from market work. Public-sector *bianzhi* employment partly legitimates high-educated wives in the marriage market.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Border Trade and Frontier Governance in China, 2015–2024

2025

Supervisor: Prof. Jian Lu

*Yangtze Institute for Development,
Nanjing University*

- Compile and harmonize provincial statistics from 2015 to 2024 to study the evolution of China's small-scale border trade across major border provinces.
- Document changes in trade volume, spatial concentration, partner-country composition, port networks, and product specialization for Xinjiang, Guangxi, Inner Mongolia, Heilongjiang, Yunnan, and Tibet.
- Provide descriptive evidence on Xinjiang's shift from a corridor-based to a hub-based border-trade pattern and discuss implications for regional trade connectivity.

China's Position in Global Value Chains under Deglobalization Risks

2024

Supervisor: Prof. Terence Chong Tai Leung

*Department of Economics, Chinese
University of Hong Kong*

- Prepare a research memo on TiVA and GVC measurement and summarize evidence on China's value capture in fragmented production networks.
- Synthesize mechanisms linking U.S.–China trade frictions and supply-chain reconfiguration to sectoral upgrading and value capture.

“Challenge Cup” College Student Academic Works Competition

2021

*Supervisor: Prof. Hao Xiao**School of Economics and Trade,**Hunan University*

- Construct a 53-country panel dataset on China–Africa engagement and agricultural trade outcomes using survey data and cross-country statistics.
- Estimate dynamic panel models (GMM) to examine how different aid categories relate to trade and contracting outcomes, and conduct robustness checks.

Innovation and Entrepreneurship Training Program, Hunan Province

2020

*Supervisor: Prof. Hao Xiao**School of Economics and Trade,**Hunan University*

- Lead a team project studying whether the composition of China’s aid predicts later contracting activity in 53 African recipient countries.
- Construct key variables from the China Aid Data and estimate dynamic panel models (GMM) under alternative specifications and diagnostic checks.
- Write the empirical section and coordinate the literature review and final report preparation.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

ECON 302, Simon Fraser University

Fall 2026

*Teaching Assistant**Instructor: Prof. Shih En Lu***ECON 331, Simon Fraser University**

Spring 2026

*Teaching Assistant**Instructor: Prof. Bertille Antoine***Mathematical Economics (M.A.), Nankai University**

Fall 2024

*Graduate Teaching Assistant**Instructor: Prof. Dianchun Jiang***Digital Economics (B.A.), Nankai University**

Spring 2024

*Teaching Assistant**Instructor: Prof. Yongjin Wang***Industrial Organization Theory (M.A.), Nankai University**

Spring 2023

*Graduate Teaching Assistant**Instructor: Prof. Yongjin Wang***HONORS AND SCHOLARSHIPS**

- Herbert G. Grubel Award, Simon Fraser University 2026
- Meiyu Li Memorial Graduate Scholarship in Economics, Simon Fraser University 2026
- Graduate Fellowship, Simon Fraser University 2026
- Special Graduate Entrance Fellowship, Simon Fraser University 2025
- Graduate Admission Scholarship for Recommended Admission without Examination, Nankai University 2022
- Special Graduate Entrance Scholarship, Nankai University 2022
- Outstanding Graduate of the Department, Hunan University 2022
- First-Class Scholarship, Hunan University 2021

COURSEWORK

Economics: Microeconomics (M.A.); Macroeconomics (M.A.); Econometric Theory (M.A.); Applied Econometrics (M.A.); Advanced Microeconomics (Ph.D., audited); Advanced Econometrics (Ph.D., audited)

Mathematics and Statistics: Math Camp (M.A., 97.5/100); Probability Theory and Mathematical Statistics; Linear Algebra; Stochastic Processes (graduate level)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Mandarin (native); English (Fluent)

Software: MATLAB, R, Stata, Python